CASH TO COMPANY · GRADE 09

a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

The Workbook for the Year

Activities, sort tasks, and reflection prompts you'll keep.

Grade 9 year theme — Entrepreneurship Is Organized Problem-Solving.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

9-12 BAND · HIGH SCHOOL

STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

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Grade 9 · Student Activity Book · the magazine version of the master document, set for adults to read end-to-end.

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GRADE 09 · STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

The Workbook for the Year

From flash of inspiration to repeatable discipline.

9

Welcome to the first year of high-school Cash to Company.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"Don't make up a winner. Decide what to test next."

This is your activity book for the year. It's the place to do the work that turns big ideas into real things. You'll fill it in, mess it up, scratch things out, and revise. That's the point.

Cash, your animated guide for the year, will pop up between sections to ask the questions that matter. Cash never tells you what to do — Cash asks what your evidence says. Get used to the question: **which people, and how do you know? Show me the evidence.**

This book mirrors the four units. Each unit has activities, projects, and reflection prompts. You'll also keep a Capstone Journal in a separate notebook — the place where you sketch, plan, and reflect at length. This book is the structured part. The journal is the messy part. You need both.

How to use this book

> "What would have to be true for you to be wrong?"
>
> - CASH, GRADE 9

- **Date every entry.** Future-you will care.
- **Quote your evidence.** When you write what a customer said, use their actual words. Made-up quotes are not evidence; they're imagination dressed up as fact.
- **Don't skip the reflection prompts.** They look optional. They are not.
- **It's okay to be wrong on Day 1.** The whole year is built around finding out where you were wrong, fast.
- **Flag your assumptions.** Where you don't yet have evidence, write "ASSUMPTION" next to it. The point is honesty, not pretend rigor.

Unit 1 — Map the model

Activity 1.1 — Day 1 Riskiest Assumption

What kind of business are you imagining for your Capstone? One sentence:

Now write your Day 1 Riskiest Assumption. The format is exact:

"This venture only works if _____."

Which Business Model Canvas box does this assumption sit in? Circle one:

| Customer segments | Value proposition | Channels | Customer relationships | | Revenue streams | Key resources | Key activities | Key partners | Cost structure |

What would you do, between now and Week 36, to find out whether this assumption is true?

Predict: By Week 36, this assumption will be... (circle one)

| (a) Confirmed | (b) Revised but largely intact | (c) Broken entirely | (d) I don't know yet |

One sentence why:

Activity 1.2 — Skills + Hobbies + Needs Inventory (9-12 version)

Fill each section with at least 4 entries. Be specific.

Skills I have or could build to a paying-level in the next year:

1.
2.
3.
4.

Things I already do that someone, somewhere, has paid for:

1.
2.
3.
4.

Frustrations I observe in people I know (problems they complain about):

1.
2.
3.
4.

Three Capstone candidate ideas this inventory suggests:

A. _____

B. _____

C. _____

Activity 1.3 — Canvas-Shaped vs. Preference Sort

For each statement, mark **C** (Canvas-shaped — would change the business model if wrong) or **P** (preference — about the founder, not the business).

___ I think 14-year-olds will pay $10/month for a study-prep newsletter. ___ I want my logo to be in green and gold. ___ I'm assuming my older brother will agree to be my key partner for shipping. ___ It would be cool to have a podcast. ___ I think parents in suburban areas check Facebook for kid-related services. ___ My venture should feel "premium." ___ I'm assuming the 30-minute session length is long enough to deliver value. ___ I want it to be the kind of business my grandparents would understand.

Reflection (3–4 sentences): Why does the Canvas-shaped vs. preference distinction matter? Which type would you rather find out is wrong — and why?

Activity 1.4 — The Nine Boxes (Canvas v1)

Fill in your Business Model Canvas v1. For each box, mark each entry with **(E)** for evidence-backed or **(A)** for flagged assumption.

1. Customer segments — Who specifically?

2. Value proposition — What frustration do you address?

3. Channels — How do customers find you and get the product?

4. Customer relationships — What's the ongoing relationship?

5. Revenue streams — How do you actually make money?

6. Key resources — What do you need to deliver?

7. Key activities — What do you actually do?

8. Key partners — Who do you need on your side?

9. Cost structure — What does this cost to run?

Riskiest box: _____ Why:

Activity 1.5 — Canvas Pack Memo (Checkpoint 1)

Write a 1-page memo titled "My Canvas, My Riskiest Assumption, and What I'd Test First." Required sections:

1. **One-sentence venture description.**
2. **Riskiest assumption (which Canvas box and why).**
3. **What I'd do in the next 4 weeks to find out.**
4. **What would change in my Canvas if I were wrong.**

Use the back of this page or your Capstone Journal for the full memo.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 09

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

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Unit 2 — Discover the customer

Activity 2.1 — Mom Test Sort

For each interview question, mark **Pass** (Mom-Test-pass) or **F** (fail). For fails, tag the failure type: **C** (compliment), **H** (hypothetical), **G** (generic).

___ "Tell me about the last time you sat down to do homework — what made it hard?" ___ "Would you pay $15 for an app that helps you with homework?" ___ "Don't you think kids your age struggle with math?" ___ "Walk me through your last study session, moment by moment." ___ "What do most teens do to handle homework stress?" ___ "When was the last time you actually paid for something to help with school?" ___ "Would you tell your friends about this?" ___ "When did you last recommend something school-related to a friend? What did you say?"

Activity 2.2 — Rewrite Three Fails

Pick three of the fails above and rewrite each as a Mom-Test-pass.

Fail 1: _____

Pass: _____

Fail 2: _____

Pass: _____

Fail 3: _____

Pass: _____

Activity 2.3 — Interview Script Builder

Write 7 questions for your customer interviews. At least 5 must be Mom-Test-passes.

#	Question	Mom-Test-pass?
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

Self-check: Read each question to a partner. If your partner can answer it the way you'd hope without thinking, it's probably leading or pitching. Rewrite.

Activity 2.4 — Interview Transcript Page (Use 5 Pages, One per Interview)

Date:	Interview #:
Interviewee initials only:	Their relationship to me:
Setting (where the interview happened):	

Their actual words (no paraphrasing):

Q1: _____ **A:** _____

Q2: _____ **A:** _____

(Continue. Yes, write what they said, not what you wished they said.)

One thing that surprised me in this interview:

Activity 2.5 — Four-Color Coding Tally

After re-reading all 5 transcripts with highlighters (yellow = problem, blue = workaround, pink = surprise, green = quote worth keeping):

Yellow tally (problems):

Problem named	Mentioned by # of interviewees

Blue tally (workarounds):

Workaround	Mentioned by # of interviewees

Pink (biggest surprise): What surprised you most across all 5?

Green (best quote to keep verbatim):

"_____"

— Interviewee **, Interview #**

Activity 2.6 — Hypothesis Revision Memo

Write a 1-page memo titled "What Changed in My Hypothesis." Required sections (use Capstone Journal for the full draft):

1. **My pattern (yellow).** "Across 5 interviews, [N] mentioned [problem]." Cite 2 quotes.
2. **My quiet signal.** "One interviewee said [**_**]**. If true, this would change [**_]."
3. **My biggest surprise.** "I expected [**_**]**. I learned [**_]. This makes me revise [____]."
4. **Changes to my Canvas (at minimum 2 boxes).** "Box X: was [**_**]**, now [**_], because [evidence]."

Activity 2.7 — Positioning Statement

Use the exact form:

"For _____ who _____, _____ is the _____ that _____ because _____."

Self-check: Every blank filled with a specific (not "everyone")? Every blank can cite at least one piece of interview evidence? If not, revise.

Activity 2.8 — Canvas v2 (Mark Every Change)

Build Canvas v2 on a blank Canvas template. For every box that changed since v1, mark a red dot and write a one-sentence "evidence change":

Box that changed: _____

v1 said: _____

v2 says: _____

Driven by evidence from interview #___: "_____"

(Repeat for each changed box. Aim for at least 3 red dots if your interviews actually surprised you.)

Unit 3 — Model the money

Activity 3.1 — One-Year P&L

Build the P&L for your Capstone. Show your math.

Revenue:

Line item	Price	Volume (per period)	Period count	Annual revenue
Total revenue				

COGS (Cost of Goods Sold — variable per unit):

Line item	Cost per unit	Volume	Annual COGS
Total COGS			

Gross margin: Revenue – COGS = $__ **(**___ %)

Operating expenses (OpEx — fixed):

Line item	Annual cost
Subscriptions / software	
Advertising	
Fees / commissions	
Other	
Total OpEx	

Net income: Gross margin – OpEx = $_____

Activity 3.2 — Two-Scenario Sensitivity

Pick the two inputs you're least sure about (usually price and volume). Run a worst case (drop both 30%) and best case (raise both 30%).

Scenario	Revenue	COGS	Gross margin	OpEx	Net income
Worst case (−30%)					
Base case (your numbers)					
Best case (+30%)					

Riskiest number: _____

Why: _____

To check this number, I would: _____

Activity 3.3 — Compliance Checklist

For your Capstone, complete the checklist:

Item	Applies (Y/N)?	What to do	Who to ask	Status
Business license				
Sales tax registration				
ID-required products				
Age limits on platforms				
PII protection				

The compliance item I take most seriously: _____

Why: _____

The one I'm least sure about: _____

I'd find out by: _____

Activity 3.4 — Functional Breakdown (3–5 Areas, OSO)

Break your venture into 3–5 functional areas. For each, write one objective and identify one dependency.

Area 1: _____

- Objective: _____
- Dependency on another area: _____

Area 2: _____

- Objective: _____
- Dependency: _____

Area 3: _____

- Objective: _____
- Dependency: _____

(Add Area 4 and 5 if they apply.)

Unit 4 — Test the bet

> **“Some of this is hard because the world's hard. The skill is knowing what's in your hands.”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 9

Activity 4.1 — MVP Test Plan

Assumption being tested (which Canvas box): _____

What I'm doing (the actual activity): _____

What-would-have-to-be-true metric (one number): _____

Kill rule: If result is _, I will _____

Iterate rule: If result is _, I will _____

Scale rule: If result is _, I will _____

Compliance check (cross-reference Activity 3.3): _____

Premortem — three reasons this test could fail in a way that invalidates the data:

1.
2.
3.

Timeline:

- Week 1 actions: _____
- Week 2 actions: _____
- Decision day: _____

Partner sign-off: Name ___ **Date** ____

Activity 4.2 — Conflict-Handling Self-Inventory

Rate each statement 1 (rarely me) to 5 (often me). Tally for each style at the end.

#	Statement	1	2	3	4	5
1	I avoid bringing up disagreements when I'm not sure how it will land.					
2	I tend to give in if it'll keep the peace.					
3	I stand my ground when I think I'm right.					
4	I look for a quick split-the-difference solution.					
5	I look for a solution that meets everyone's interests.					
6	If a conflict feels minor, I let it go.					
7	I focus on the other person's needs more than mine.					
8	I push hard for what I believe in, even if others disagree.					
9	I'm comfortable trading off if it ends the conversation faster.					
10	I take time to really understand the other side before suggesting anything.					
11	I postpone hard conversations when emotions are running hot.					
12	I'd rather work it out fully than settle for "good enough."					

Tallies:

- Avoid (#1, 6, 11): ____
- Accommodate (#2, 7): ____
- Compete (#3, 8): ____
- Compromise (#4, 9): ____
- Collaborate (#5, 10, 12): ____

My default conflict-handling style: _____

One style I want to improve: _____

Why: _____

Three small ways I'll practice this in the next 4 weeks:

1.
2.
3.

Activity 4.3 — MVP Test Results + Recommendation

After running the test, fill in:

Pre-committed WWHTBT metric: _____

Actual result: _____

Did the result clearly signal kill, iterate, or scale? Circle: **Kill · Iterate · Scale · Inconclusive**

Reasoning (3–5 sentences):

What this changes about my Canvas (if anything):

Three things I'd do differently if I ran this test again:

1.
2.
3.

Activity 4.4 — Year-End Synthesis (Final Reflection)

Use the Capstone Journal for the full draft. Required sections (1 page minimum):

1. **The biggest thing I got wrong on Day 1.**
2. **The piece of customer evidence that changed my Canvas the most.**
3. **The riskiest number on my P&L and how I'd check it.**
4. **My MVP recommendation and why.**
5. **My conflict-handling default — and the move I'm most proud of practicing this year.**
6. **One thing I'd tell next year's Grade 9 student.**

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 09

"Most adults skip the step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

2

Cash's questions to keep on the wall (year-round)

- Which people, and how do you know? Show me the evidence.
- What assumption in your Canvas would, if wrong, sink the whole thing?
- What would have to be true for your P&L to actually happen?
- What's the smallest test that could change your mind?
- Which compliance item applies to your venture, and what are you going to do about it?
- When you and a teammate disagree, what's your default — and is it the right move here?

Vocabulary Spine (running list — add as you go)

Term	Date introduced	My definition (in my own words)
Business Model Canvas		
Hypothesis		
Riskiest assumption		
Assumption flag		
Mom Test		
Customer discovery		
Code		
Pattern		
Quiet signal		
Positioning statement		
Segmentation		
Revenue		
COGS		
Gross margin		
Operating expenses		
Net income		
Unit economics		
Sensitivity		
Runway		
Sales tax		
Business license		
PII		
MVP		
What-would-have-to-be-true		

Term	Date introduced	My definition (in my own words)
Kill / iterate / scale		
Premortem		

(Use the back of the book for additional terms as the year goes on. Aim for a Frayer entry on each "weight-bearing" term — Canvas, contribution margin, MVP, premortem, positioning.)

Senior expert upgrade pack — Deliberate practice (Grade 9)

Practice A — BMC with assumption flags

Re-do your BMC. For each box, mark a flag:

Box	Content	Flag (confirmed / hypothesis / imagined)
Customers		
Value proposition		
Channels		
Customer relationships		
Revenue streams		
Key activities		
Key resources		
Key partners		
Cost structure		

How many "confirmed"? Less than 3 means more interviews are needed.

Practice B — One-year P&L with two scenarios

Build a base-case P&L. Then build an optimistic and pessimistic version.

	Optimistic	Base	Pessimistic
Revenue			
COGS			
Gross margin			
Operating expenses			
Net income			

What variable changes most across scenarios? ___

Practice C — Service agreement draft for your Capstone

If your Capstone is a service: draft a 1-page service agreement.

1. **Who: _____**
2. **What: _____**
3. **When: _____**
4. **How much: _____**
5. **What if: _____**

If your Capstone is a product: draft a return-and-refund policy in plain English (1 paragraph).

Practice D — Compliance Map

For your Capstone:

Item	Applies?	What I'll do about it
Business license	Y / N / TBD	
Sales tax	Y / N / TBD	
ID-required products (e.g., over-18 items)	Y / N / TBD	
Age limits on labor	Y / N / TBD	
PII (customer data)	Y / N / TBD	

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 9 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“From flash of inspiration to repeatable discipline.”**

- CASH, GRADE 9

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).